

For progression of skills Nursery to Year 2, please visit the Phonics and Early Reading section of our website.

Skills	Year 3	Year 4	Year 5	Year 6
Vocabulary	I can use the context of a sentence to help me understand the meaning of unfamiliar words. I can use a dictionary to check the meaning of words I have read. I can use features such as a glossary to find the meaning of unfamiliar or subject-specific vocabulary. I can discuss words and phrases that capture my interest and imagination. I can explain the meaning of words in the context in which they are used. I can make links between new vocabulary and words I already know.	I can use context to work out the likely meaning of unfamiliar words and check my understanding. I can use dictionaries and glossaries efficiently to clarify the meaning of unfamiliar vocabulary. I can explain the meaning of words and phrases within increasingly challenging texts. I can discuss words and phrases that capture the reader's interest and imagination. I can identify words and phrases that contribute to the mood or meaning of a text. I can explain why an author may have selected a particular word or phrase. I can recognise when a familiar word has a different meaning depending on its context.	I can use context and my existing vocabulary knowledge to explore the meaning of unfamiliar words and phrases. I can use a dictionary confidently to check and refine my understanding of unfamiliar vocabulary. I can explain how the meaning of a word or phrase is shaped by its context. I can identify and explain examples of figurative language, including simile, metaphor and personification. I can discuss how an author's choice of words and phrases contributes to meaning, mood and atmosphere. I can explain the effect that particular vocabulary choices have on the reader. I can compare vocabulary choices within or across texts.	I can independently use context and reference materials to establish and refine the meaning of unfamiliar vocabulary. I can explain the meaning of increasingly sophisticated words and phrases in context. I can explore how words can have different meanings, associations and effects depending on their context. I can analyse how an author's vocabulary choices contribute to meaning, tone, mood and atmosphere. I can explain and evaluate the effect of figurative language on the reader. I can select precise evidence from a text to support my explanation of an author's language choices. I can compare how different authors use vocabulary and figurative language to achieve particular effects.

Inference	I can infer a character's feelings, thoughts and motives from their actions. I can identify evidence in the text that supports my inference. I can explain how a character's actions or words give me clues about what they might be thinking or feeling.	I can draw inferences about characters' feelings, thoughts and motives from their actions, words and behaviour. I can select relevant evidence from the text to justify my inferences. I can use clues from different parts of a text to develop my understanding of a character or event.	I can draw and justify inferences using evidence from across a text, including where meaning is implied rather than directly stated. I can explain how a character's actions, dialogue and behaviour reveal their feelings, thoughts and motives. I can select and combine evidence from different parts of a text to support my interpretation. I can recognise that different interpretations may be possible and explain my reasoning.	I can develop and justify increasingly complex inferences by combining evidence from different parts of a text. I can infer characters' feelings, thoughts, motives and relationships, including where these change or develop across a text. I can select precise evidence and explain how it supports my interpretation. I can consider different interpretations of a text and evaluate which evidence supports them.
Prediction	I can predict what might happen next using details that are stated in the text. I can use clues about characters, events and settings to make sensible predictions. I can explain my prediction using evidence from the text.	I can predict what might happen using details that are stated and implied in the text. I can use evidence from different parts of a text to support my predictions. I can use my knowledge of characters, events and similar texts to make and justify predictions.	I can make predictions using evidence that is stated and implied across a text. I can select relevant evidence from different parts of a text to justify my predictions. I can use my understanding of characters, themes, genre and plot development to inform my predictions. I can review and refine my predictions as I encounter new information.	I can make and justify predictions by combining stated and implied evidence from across a text. I can select precise evidence to explain why an outcome is likely. I can draw on my understanding of characters, themes, genre, structure and plot development when making predictions. I can evaluate and revise my predictions in response to new or conflicting evidence.
Explanation	I can identify themes and conventions in books I read. I can explain how words and phrases	I can identify and discuss themes and conventions across a range of texts. I can explain how language, structure	I can identify and discuss themes and conventions within and across texts. I can explain how language, structure	I can analyse how themes and conventions are developed within and across texts.

	contribute to the meaning of a text. I can identify how features such as headings, subheadings, paragraphs, captions and diagrams help me understand a text. I can ask questions to improve my understanding of a text. I can explain my understanding and support my ideas with evidence from the text. I can prepare and perform poems and play scripts, using appropriate intonation, tone, volume and action.	and presentation contribute to meaning. I can explain how an author uses words and phrases to create particular effects. I can ask relevant questions to deepen my understanding of a text. I can explain and justify my ideas using relevant evidence from the text. I can recognise and discuss different forms of poetry. I can prepare and perform poems and play scripts, using intonation, tone, volume and action to communicate meaning.	and presentation contribute to meaning and affect the reader. I can discuss and evaluate how authors use language, including figurative language, considering its impact on the reader. I can make comparisons within and across books. I can recommend books to others and give reasons for my choices. I can explain and discuss my understanding of what I have read, supporting my views with evidence. I can prepare and perform poems and plays, using intonation, tone and volume so that meaning is clear to an audience.	I can explain and evaluate how language, structure and presentation contribute to meaning and influence the reader. I can evaluate how authors use language, including figurative language, and explain its impact on the reader. I can make detailed comparisons within and across texts, identifying similarities and differences in authors' choices. I can explain and discuss my understanding through discussion, presentations and debate, maintaining a clear focus and using evidence to support my ideas. I can provide reasoned justifications for my views and respond thoughtfully to different interpretations. I can prepare and perform poems and plays, making deliberate choices about intonation, tone and volume to communicate meaning effectively.
Retrieval	I can retrieve information from a text to answer questions. I can locate key words and phrases in a text to find relevant information. I can use organisational features such as contents pages, headings, subheadings, glossaries and indexes to locate	I can retrieve relevant information from fiction and non-fiction texts. I can skim and scan a text to locate specific information efficiently. I can select relevant words, phrases and details from a text to answer questions accurately.	I can retrieve, record and present relevant information from non-fiction texts. I can skim and scan increasingly complex texts to locate information efficiently. I can select precise information and evidence from different parts of a text	I can efficiently retrieve, record and present information from a range of increasingly complex texts. I can select precise and relevant information from different parts of a text to answer questions fully. I can retrieve and combine information from across a text, recognising where I

	information. I can retrieve and record information from non-fiction texts.	I can retrieve and record information from different sections of a non-fiction text. I can use organisational features to locate information efficiently.	to answer questions. I can distinguish between statements of fact and opinion. I can retrieve and combine information from different sections of a text.	need to draw on more than one source of information. I can distinguish between statements of fact and opinion and explain how I know. I can identify the most relevant evidence when several pieces of information could be used to answer a question.
Sequencing/ Summarising	I can sequence the main events in a text in the correct order. I can orally retell events from a range of texts, including fairy stories, myths and legends. I can identify the main idea of a paragraph or section of text. I can identify the main ideas from more than one paragraph and begin to summarise them. I can distinguish between important information and additional detail when retelling a text.	I can sequence and retell the key events in a text, selecting the most important information. I can identify the main ideas drawn from more than one paragraph. I can summarise the main ideas of a section of text in my own words. I can select key details that support the main ideas. I can explain how events or ideas are connected across a text.	I can summarise the main ideas drawn from more than one paragraph, identifying key details that support them. I can identify and select the most significant information when summarising a text. I can summarise longer sections of a text concisely without including unnecessary detail. I can identify themes and conventions that develop across a text. I can explain how key events or ideas contribute to the overall meaning of a text.	I can summarise the main ideas from increasingly complex texts, selecting precise details that support them. I can synthesise information from different parts of a text into a concise summary. I can distinguish between key information and supporting or incidental detail. I can summarise how ideas, events, themes or characters develop across a whole text. I can adapt the detail included in a summary according to its purpose.
Wider Reading Skills	I can listen to, read and discuss a wide range of fiction, poetry, plays, non-fiction and reference books. I can read books that are structured in	I can read and discuss an increasingly wide range of fiction, poetry, plays, non-fiction and reference books. I can read books that are structured in	I can read and discuss an increasingly wide range of fiction, poetry, plays, non-fiction and reference books. I can read books that are structured in	I can independently read and discuss a broad and increasingly challenging range of fiction, poetry, plays, non-fiction and reference texts.

	different ways and for a range of purposes. I can increase my familiarity with a range of books, including fairy stories, myths and legends. I can talk about books I have read and listened to, sharing my ideas and preferences. I can participate in discussions about books, taking turns and listening to what others say. I can read and enjoy books independently and make choices about what I would like to read.	different ways and select texts for different purposes. I can increase my familiarity with a wide range of books, including fairy stories, myths and legends. I can discuss books I have read, explaining my responses and preferences. I can participate actively in discussions about books, building on the ideas of others and listening to different views. I can make increasingly independent choices about what I read and explain my choices.	different ways and for a range of purposes. I can increase my familiarity with myths, legends, traditional stories, modern fiction, fiction from our literary heritage and books from other cultures and traditions. I can learn and perform a wider range of poetry by heart. I can discuss books confidently, building on my own and others' ideas and respectfully challenging different views. I can recommend books to others, giving reasons for my choices. I can make purposeful and increasingly independent choices about my personal reading.	I can read texts with different structures, styles and purposes and adapt how I read accordingly. I can draw on a broad familiarity with myths, legends, traditional stories, modern fiction, fiction from our literary heritage and books from other cultures and traditions. I can learn, rehearse and perform a wider range of poetry by heart. I can contribute thoughtfully to discussions about books, building on others' ideas, challenging views courteously and justifying my own responses. I can make connections between books I have read and explain similarities and differences in my reading experiences. I can independently select, discuss and recommend books, giving considered reasons for my choices.
Vocabulary	Context, definition, dictionary, glossary, vocabulary, character, setting, event, evidence, inference, prediction, retrieve, sequence, summary, main idea, theme, fiction, non-fiction, poetry, author, reader, paragraph, heading, subheading, contents, index	Context, word choice, effect, mood, synonym, evidence, inference, implied, prediction, retrieve, skim, scan, sequence, summary, main idea, key detail, theme, convention, structure, presentation, viewpoint, justify, fiction, non-fiction, poetry	Figurative language, simile, metaphor, personification, imagery, context, effect, mood, atmosphere, evidence, inference, implied meaning, interpretation, prediction, retrieve, fact, opinion, summarise, key detail, theme, convention, compare, contrast, structure, presentation, justify	Connotation, literal, figurative, imagery, tone, mood, atmosphere, effect, evidence, inference, interpretation, implied meaning, prediction, retrieve, synthesise, summarise, key detail, theme, convention, analyse, evaluate, compare, contrast, viewpoint, structure, presentation, justify